



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Emotional Intelligence

HUMAN RESOURCES MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of effective communications.
2. Foster positive working relationships.
3. Build trust in relationships.
4. Consider conflicting viewpoints.
5. Enlist others in working toward a shared vision.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the Human Resources Manager at STRATOSPHERE SOLUTIONS, a rapidly growing software development firm. The Vice President of Operations (judge) has asked you to intervene in a "turf war" between two departments that is threatening a major product launch.

STRATOSPHERE SOLUTIONS employs 120 people. Recently, the company has experienced friction between the Sales Department and the Product Development Team.

The Vice President (judge) has informed you that the Product Development Team feels the Sales Department is making "impossible promises" to clients to close deals, forcing developers to work overtime to build features that don't exist yet. Conversely, the Sales Department claims the Product Developers are "gatekeeping" information and refusing to prioritize client needs, which affects commissions and company revenue.

This conflict has evolved into toxic office politics. The two departments have stopped speaking to one another directly, relying on passive-aggressive emails. They have also begun keeping "score" of each other's mistakes to report to upper management.

The Vice President (judge) wants you to develop a conflict resolution strategy to end this turf war. Your presentation must include:

- An analysis of why this "turf war" is happening and the risks it poses to the company culture.
- A strategy to facilitate a mediation meeting between the two department heads to resolve their differences.
- A plan to foster positive working relationships between the opposing teams (e.g., joint training or team building).
- A method for establishing a "shared vision" so both teams understand they are working toward the same goal.

You will present your recommendations to the Vice President (judge) in a role-play to take place in the Vice President's (judge's) office. The Vice President (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your strategy. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the Vice President's (judge's) questions, the Vice President (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do we get these teams to trust one another again after this conflict?
2. Provide some specific examples of how you can facilitate positive work relationships between these teams again.

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of effective communications?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Foster positive working relationships?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Build trust in relationships?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Consider conflicting viewpoints?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Enlist others in working toward a shared vision?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						